

September 11, 2026

Climate Reserve Hiring Team

Aspen Global Change Institute

RE: PROGRAM ASSOCIATE, CLIMATE RESERVE

Dear Hiring Team,

I'm excited to apply for the Program Associate role with Climate Reserve because the work sits at an intersection I've spent much of my career navigating: climate and environmental science, decision-support, technology, and the people and institutions that turn technical information into action.

My perspective on the vulnerability of this ecosystem is grounded in experience. I spent three years working within the **National Park Service's** science and mapping infrastructure, and later worked at **Teren**, a geospatial-risk company whose work depended on environmental regulatory processes for oil and gas infrastructure. At Teren, I worked with machine-learning models built from drone and satellite imagery to assess environmental risk around oil and gas sites and land near national park boundaries—including surface hydrology, habitat encroachment, invasive species, and other environmental conditions. **That experience taught me how technical environmental information becomes useful only when it can be translated into a decision, a risk assessment, or an action by someone operating in the real world.**

That same translation has been a through-line in my work. At Lytics, I led a multi-stakeholder enterprise engagement, translating complex customer-data problems between engineering, business, and client teams. At Homebot, I helped build and manage a technical team while translating product and customer insights for non-technical stakeholders. Across these roles, I've consistently operated as the connective tissue between technical work and the people who need to make decisions from it— while managing the details and systems that keep complex projects moving.

I also bring a broader perspective on the climate decision-support ecosystem. My background is in geography and GIS, including an Honors spatial-statistics thesis (which dived into trends on organic agriculture tourism), and I've worked across public lands, environmental regulation, geospatial technology, disaster response, and climate-related infrastructure. I currently advise an early-stage startup developing software for small water and wastewater utilities, focused on helping operators use data and AI to manage aging infrastructure, regulatory requirements, and climate-related operational pressures. That work has given me a close view of the challenges facing subnational infrastructure and the importance of connecting technical expertise with the people making decisions on the ground.

I'm particularly drawn to Climate Reserve's emphasis on both rescue and reinvention. Preserving critical expertise matters, but so does building a more distributed and resilient system for producing, connecting, and applying that expertise over the long term. I would bring to that work a combination of research and synthesis skills, technical fluency, project management, CRM and data-system experience, and the ability to move comfortably between strategic questions and the practical work required to answer them.

I'm based in Boulder and have strong ties to the Roaring Fork Valley and would be open to moving back. I'd welcome the opportunity to bring my climate, technology, and cross-sector experience to Climate Reserve and help strengthen the human infrastructure behind climate decision-making.

Thank you for considering my application. I'd love the opportunity to talk.

Warmly,

Katrina Engelsted

BOULDER, COLORADO